

WEB DESIGNER ROADMAP

WORKBOOK



WELCOME,

This workbook is your roadmap to becoming a well-paid web designer.

Not by learning everything.

But, by learning the right things in the right order.

You don't need to master every tool or trend.

You need a clear path, real projects, and skills that actually compound.

Use this as a reference.

Come back to it as you grow.

And build one piece at a time.

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WATCH THE VIDEO

WEB DEVELOPMENT

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UX DESIGN

DIGITAL MARKETING

SKILL ONE

WEB DEVELOPMENT

Web development is the “how it’s built” side of web design. You’re learning enough HTML/CSS (and a little JavaScript) to customize, troubleshoot, and improve sites. Most paid client work happens inside website builders, so start there and use code as your support tool.

What to learn:

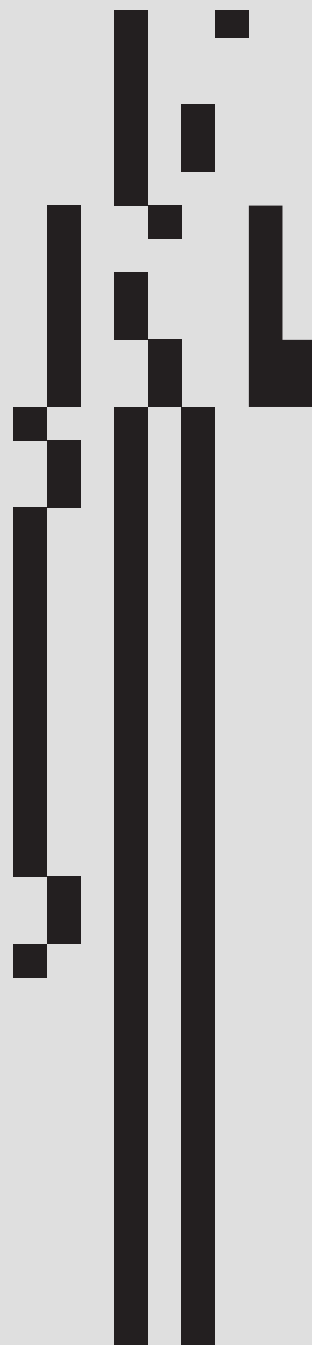
HTML basics	<i>headings, links, images, sections</i>
CSS basics	<i>spacing, typography, responsive layouts</i>
JavaScript basics	<i>how to target elements</i>
Website builder (pick one)	<i>Showit / Webflow / Squarespace / Wix</i>

What not to learn:

JavaScript libraries	<i>React / Vue / Angular</i>
CSS frameworks	<i>Tailwind / Bootstrap/Sass</i>
Backend + databases + APIs	<i>MySQL / Firebase / GraphQL</i>

Codecademy Links

HTML Basics
CSS Basics
JavaScript



SKILL TWO

BRAND DESIGN

Brand design is how a business makes someone feel. As a web designer, your job isn't to invent a brand every time. It's to understand the brand that exists (or doesn't yet) and extend it clearly across the site. This is one of the biggest reasons some designers charge \$1,500 and others charge \$5,000+.

What to learn:

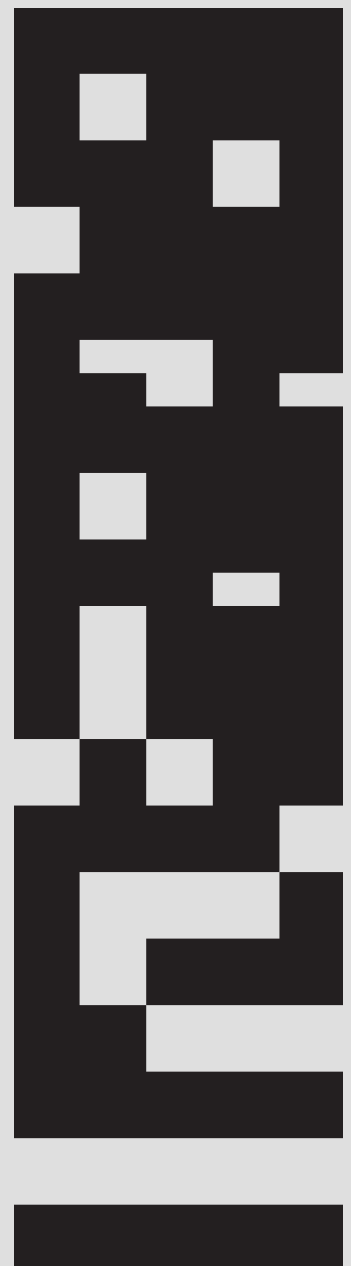
Color	<i>60/30/10: neutrals + brand + accent</i>
Typography	<i>font categories, contrast, restraint</i>
Images	<i>consistency, tone, avoiding generic stock</i>

What not to learn (yet):

Full brand identity systems
Complex logo theory
Advanced illustration or motion branding

Tools

<u>Kittl</u>
<u>Canva</u>
<u>Photoshop & Illustrator</u>



SKILL THREE

UX DESIGN

UX design is about making a website easy to use without people having to think. You can have great branding, but if users feel confused, stuck, or unsure what to do next, they leave. UX is how people move through a site, understand it, and take action.

What to learn:

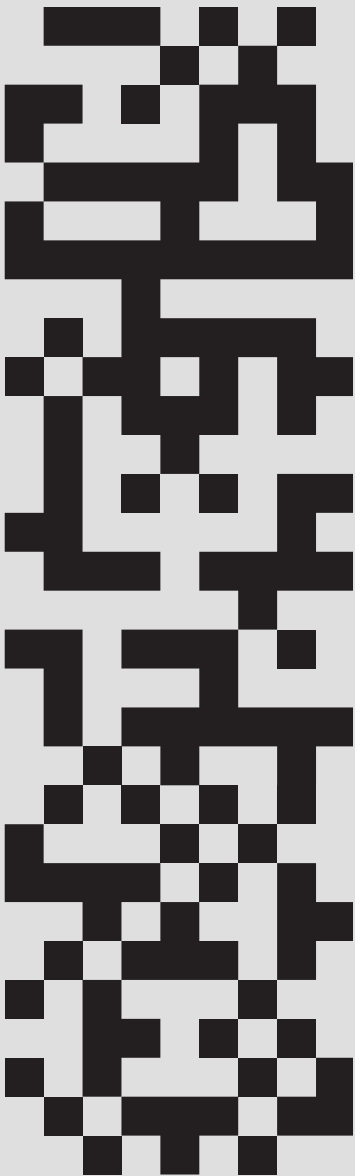
User testing	<i>watching real people use the site</i>
User flow	<i>clear paths from entry to action</i>
Visual hierarchy	<i>showing what matters most first</i>
Accessibility basics	<i>readable text, keyboard navigation</i>

What not to learn (yet):

Advanced UX theory
Complex personas or journey maps
Enterprise research processes

Tools

<u>Figma</u>



SKILL THREE

DIGITAL MARKETING

Digital marketing is how a website actually helps a business grow. A site can look great and be easy to use, but if no one shows up—or no one takes action—it doesn't matter. Digital marketing connects your design work directly to money.

What to learn:

SEO basics	<i>helping pages show up in search</i>
Conversion thinking	<i>turning visitors into customers</i>
Analytics	<i>knowing what's working and what's not</i>
Key actions	<i>orms, bookings, purchases</i>

What not to learn (yet):

Advanced ad platforms
Complex funnels or automation
Deep analytics theory

Tools

<u>Google Analytics</u>
<u>A/B Testing (later)</u>



FINAL THOUGHTS,

QUESTION: When can you consider yourself a web designer?

ANSWER: When you start building a website.

You don't need to have everything figured out. What you need is the next project.

Get a client. Build the site. Then on the next one, stack one more skill.

Don't overthink it.

This is how real web designers grow. Not all at once, but one project at a time.

It won't be easy. But it'll be worth it.

If you don't quit, you win.